



Читать без отвлекающих факторов на Substack

Самая человечная из когда-либо созданных технологий

Большинство людей не пытаются экономить время. Они пытаются его потратить



АНИШ А

13 июля 2026 г.

🔊 Прос



Америка | Технологии | Мнение | Культура | Графики

Люди счастливее, когда что-то делают своими руками. Стол, который ваш сын сделал сам, лучше того, что он заказал в West Elm. К обеду дети бросают свои дорогие игрушки, а потом всю неделю строят в подвале форт из коробок, в которых их привезли. Мы знаем это о себе, но все равно периодически забываем отчасти потому, что большинство технологий последних ста лет были созданы для обратного: чтобы у нас было больше, а делали мы меньше.

упомянула, если бы меня спросили, что делает жизнь стоящей. Кисть для рисования никогда не сэкономила ни минуты, а мы держим их под рукой уже десятки тысяч лет.

Некоторое время назад Евгения Куйда, которая много лет занимается разработкой потребительских продуктов на основе искусственного интеллекта, сказала мне кое-что, к чему я постоянно возвращаюсь. По ее словам, большинство людей не пытаются экономить время. Они пытаются его тратить.

Почти все, что кто-либо говорит об искусственном интеллекте, будь то за или против, — это спор о времени. Отнимет ли ИИ рабочие места или расширит? Сколько минут модель сэкономила на написании служебной записки, а затем ее прочтении? Стоили ли токены своих денег?

Но, на мой взгляд, самое интересное в искусственном интеллекте — это то, что он относится и к другому типу технологий, к тем, что позволяют нам, людям, выражать себя. Некоторым технологиям в истории удалось стать и тем, и другим: печатный станок и паровой двигатель — все эти инструменты сэкономили огромное количество труда и, как бы побочно, расширили возможности человека. Искусственный интеллект относится к этой небольшой категории. Он делает созидание более возможным.

Почему созидание значит гораздо больше, чем потребление? В конце жизни Оливер Сакс пришел к идее, к которой я постоянно возвращаюсь. Он заметил, что большинство людей воспринимают присутствие в настоящем как цель, как будто смысл жизни в том, чтобы находиться в текущем моменте. Он считал, что это немного печально. Люди, которых он считал наиболее живыми, были погружены в прошлое и будущее одновременно: они вспоминали, планировали, мечтали. Вот что делает с человеком созидание. Это растягивает вас во всех временах, потому что вы стремитесь к чему-то, что уже видите, отталкиваясь от всего, что вам когда-либо было дорого. Поглощение, напротив, удерживает вас в настоящем.

превратилось в соревнование. В борьбу за внимание. А когда за дело взялись алгоритмы, то стало очевидно, что побеждает тот, кто громче всех кричит. Поэтому люди стали оптимизировать контент под громкость, и в последнее время мы стали называть машинно-созданную версию контента шлаком.

SEE OTHER CULTURE ARTICLES

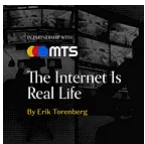
A



New Media, год спустя

ЭРИК ТОРЕНБЕРГ, АЛЕКС ДАНКО, И 5 ДРУГИХ • 18 ИЮНЯ.

[Читать статью полностью](#) →



The Internet is Real Life

ERIK TORENBORG • 21 АПР.

[Read full story](#) →

Type your email...

Subscribe

But the feed was slop before any machine got involved. Slop is just what you get when everyone consumes and nobody creates, and the cure is people making things again, which AI is unusually good at enabling. That's about the most anti-slop thing I can imagine. A companion you talk to and shape and argue with will do more for you than a celebrity you watch from across the internet, because one of them is a thing you make and the other is a thing that happens to you. It's the difference between putting on an autogenerated Spotify playlist and making somebody a mixtape. A mixtape you, smuggled into another person's afternoon.

And this isn't reserved for creatives. A master electrician **in Kentucky** with no computer science degree used AI to build a load-calculation tool that sells for \$1 and replaces a \$500 service call. A plumber **canceled a \$40,000 consulting contract** after a single afternoon with OpenClaw got him further than the consultants had

and the people picking this up first are not the ones anyone predicted. Software is about to be everywhere the way YouTube made video everywhere, and most of it will be built by people who'd never have called themselves builders.

The same thing is arriving in the time you spend at home. The McKinsey-esque (unimaginative) version of the promise of AI is that everything in your life will get 10 percent more efficient. The better version is that every year or so, you'll find one thing to fall in love with and pour your free time into it. None of this matters, in the big serious sense of the word, which is the good news, because the things that do matter are usually the things people love the most. Fan fiction. A kid DJing in his bedroom. Some ridiculous game you and your daughter invent on a rainy Saturday afternoon also where nearly every great consumer company has ever come from. As my partner Chris Dixon said, **the next big thing** will start out looking like a toy.

Work is the same story. The good part of any job is the stretch where you're doing something you're genuinely good at, and everything around it, the politics and the status and the meetings about other meetings, is a tax you pay to get there. AI is starting to eat the tax. As it shrinks, the job feels more like yours, more like the thing you'd do anyway. And the part of work that feels like play is where the real breakthroughs have always lived. The good ideas almost never climb out of strategy books. They come from some side quest a person went down because they couldn't help themselves. It's a strange weekend project, the rabbit hole that paid off.

There's an old story about the moment the hippies turned into the finest capitalist country had ever produced, well-explored in David Brooks' book **Bobo's in Paradise**. All that sixties individuality, the stuff that was supposed to be the sworn enemy of money, gradually evolved into the engine of it. The war between the strivers and rebels didn't end with a winner; it ended with a merger. Being a distinct person stopped being a rebellion and became the whole economy (some companies that exemplify this include Ben & Jerry's, Restoration Hardware, and Range Rover).

everyone else sinks into a permanent underclass, has always felt to me like the worst story. The side quests and the rabbit holes and the weekend projects don't ladder into a neat diagram of who owns what. Whatever barbell this thing creates, you'll feel it first in the texture of your own days, in what you get to make and who you get to become, long before it ever turns into a chart of how society is arranged.

Look at the people who already use this stuff all day. They haven't gone limp and checked out. They're working more, and they're further into it. People who spent years as spectators of their own ambitions are finally actualizing them. Give someone the means to build the thing they've been carrying around in their head, and they do lean back. They lean in. They stay up too late, and they text you at 2am to show you what happened.

A few months ago I went on a strange guys' trip where the daily routine was four hours on our laptops in the morning, then padel, then a long dinner, and the dinner was mostly four grown men showing each other what they'd built that morning. It felt like the future to me, mostly because of how badly everyone wanted to show their work.

Here's what I think happens when execution gets cheap. For most of history, the bottleneck on making something was never the idea, it was the grind: acquiring 10 years of skill, raising the money, assembling the team, and getting the permission. For most people's best ideas died inside them, unmade. Lift that bottleneck and the thing that decides what gets built is no longer whether people can justify the VC funding the enterprise-level capital expenditure, but who has something to say. The most human thing about you stops being a private quirk and starts being the point.

Individuality was supposed to be the luxury you bought once you'd made it. I think it's about to become the thing everyone gets to spend their life on, the work itself. So when I picture where this goes, I see a lot of people making strange, beautiful, slightly pointless things and handing them around to see what happens. The toys were finally made. But we always wanted to play with the boxes.



Software's YouTube moment is happening now

ANISH A • 15 ЯНВ.

[Read full story](#) →



The future of the web is the history of YouTube

ANISH A • 28 ОКТЯБРЯ 2025 Г.

[Read full story](#) →

Subscribe

This newsletter is provided for informational purposes only, and should not be relied upon as legal, business, investment, or tax advice. Furthermore, this content is not investment advice, nor is it intended for use by any investors or prospective investors in any a16z funds. This newsletter may link to other websites or contain other information obtained from third-party sources - a16z has not independently verified nor makes any representations about the current or enduring accuracy of such information. If this content includes third-party advertisements, a16z has not reviewed such advertisements and does not endorse any advertising content or related companies contained therein. Any investments or portfolio companies mentioned referred to, or described are not representative of all investments in vehicles managed by a16z; visit <https://a16z.com/investment-list/> for a full list of investments. Other important information can be found at a16z.com/disclosures. You're receiving this newsletter since you opted in earlier; if you would like to opt out of future newsletters you may unsubscribe immediately.

Subscribe to a16z

Launched 6 years ago

It's time to build.

Subscribe



158 Likes · 17 Restacks

Discussion about this post

Comments Restacks



Write a comment...



Elisabeth Andrews  1d

This is the best articulation of the positive integration of this technology I've seen yet. Thank you! The paintbrush analogy is fantastic. AI is also so helpful for closing gaps in practical knowledge. For example, I never learned basic cooking skills and it's been an area of struggle and frustration until now. I am finally enjoying cooking and building confidence. It supports my creativity as I generate ideas and get step-by-step instructions on how to achieve them and failure modes to avoid.

 LIKE (3)  REPLY



Matt Jones 1d *Edited*

This is the problem when people get way, way, way too far out into Big Think instead of grounded, simple, daily reality. I don't want whatever calendar app I can make; I want the best calendar app possible, that will anticipate problems I don't even know I'll have.

Taste. Careful design. Craft. These are durable advantages and scalable to everyone.

Look at food. We have had great food-making technology for quite some time. I can make a lot of things based on my imagination in my very own home. Turns out restaurants and going out are more popular than ever because I don't want to eat my own slop. Taylorism is alive and well.

 LIKE (2)  REPLY

1 reply

